

BAO KHAM CHAU

Associate Professor of Law at University of Missouri–Kansas City
Affiliate at Harvard Berkman Klein Center
bchau@umkc.edu

Technologist, attorney, and law professor studying the regulation and institutional consequences of emerging technologies, including generative AI and digital platforms. Former Senior Software Engineer at Lyft, federal appellate clerk, and Senior Law and Technology Fellow in the U.S. Senate, bringing nearly a decade of engineering experience to scholarship, regulatory proposals, and policymaking.

EDUCATION

University of Virginia School of Law, Charlottesville, VA

J.D., May 2022

Salzburg Cutler Fellow in International Law & Public Service

LawTech Center Legal Fellow

Design and Technology Editor (Executive Board), *Virginia Journal of International Law*

Editorial Board and Technology Consultant, *Virginia Journal of Law & Technology*

Harvard University, Cambridge, MA

A.M. in Regional Studies—East Asia, November 2015

University of California at Berkeley, Berkeley, CA

B.A., triple major in Computer Science, History (Honors), and Political Science, June 2010

Additional Credentials

- Oxford University *Certificate* in Media, Law, and Policy, August 2019
- Massachusetts Institute of Technology *Certificate* in Advanced Study Program, June 2016

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

My research produces both scholarship and regulatory proposals at the intersection of law and technology through two related strands. First, I examine how AI systems—including the software, infrastructure, evaluation practices, and institutional processes surrounding their models—affect established legal frameworks such as intellectual property, administrative law, tort, and privacy. Second, I apply computational and empirical methods to legal datasets to study legal change and evaluate emerging technologies and their institutional consequences.

I draw on nearly a decade of experience working as a senior software engineer in Big Tech, where I developed patented machine-learning features for millions of users, as well as experience in patent litigation, federal courts, and the United States Senate. This unique technical-legal background informs both my scholarship and teaching, allowing me to translate complex technical systems into accessible concepts and prepare students to engage critically with emerging technologies and the regulatory institutions that govern them.

Primary: Law and Technology, Patent Law, Data Privacy, Algorithmic Governance, Internet Governance, Legislation and Regulation, Torts, Empirical Legal Research

Secondary: Civil Procedure, Professional Responsibility, Cybersecurity, Computer Law, Platform Liability, Contracts, Legal History

ACADEMIC APPOINTMENTS & AFFILIATIONS

University of Missouri–Kansas City, Kansas City, MO

Associate Professor of Law, August 2026 – Current

Harvard Berkman Klein Center for Internet and Society, Cambridge, MA

Assembly Fellow, August 2018 – December 2019

Affiliate, December 2019 – August 2020, September 2023 – Current

Harvard University Institute for Rebooting Social Media, Cambridge, MA

Advisor, May 2022 – September 2023

Cornell Tech Digital Life Initiative, New York, NY

Visiting Fellow, September 2022 – September 2023

PUBLICATIONS

Shadow Judgment: AI and the Administrative Record (in progress)

Generative AI and the Limits of Patent Law (in progress)

Which Cases Do Language Models Already Know? (coauthored manuscript in progress)

Measuring Legal Importance: From Case Citations to Linguistic Shifts

23 Nw. J. Tech. & Intell. Prop. 551 (2026)

Bao Kham Chau and George He, *Audio Deepfakes and the Regulation of the Landlords of Creativity*, Cambridge F. AI: L. & Governance (2025) (peer-reviewed)

Engineering a Fiduciary: Expanding the Regulatory Scope of Algorithmic Bias

Harv. J.L. & Tech. Dig. (2024)

Bao Kham Chau and Michael A. Livermore, *Computational Legal Studies Comes of Age*,

Eur. J. Empirical Legal Stud. (2024) (peer-reviewed)

Bao Kham Chau and Michael A. Livermore, “Studying Judicial Behavior with Text Analysis”

in *Oxford Handbook of Comparative Judicial Behaviour*, Oxford University Press (2023)

Governing the Algorithmic Turn: Lyft, Uber, and Disparate Impact

Wm. & Mary Ctr. L. & Ct. Tech. (2022) (First-place winner at the 2022 Artificial Intelligence Writing Competition)

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Data Privacy. University of Missouri–Kansas City, Kansas City, MO, Fall 2026

Law & Technology. University of Missouri–Kansas City, Kansas City, MO, Spring 2027 (scheduled)

Statutes & Regulation. University of Missouri–Kansas City, Kansas City, MO, Spring 2027 (scheduled)

Programming for Lawyers. Teaching Fellow. Harvard Law School, Cambridge, MA, Spring 2017

Introduction to Computer Science Using Java (I & II). Teaching Fellow. Harvard University, Cambridge MA, Fall 2014 – Spring 2015.

PATENTS

U.S. Pat. App. Pub. No. 2020/0126175 to Fong, Chan, **Chau**, et al. (Granted September 5, 2023)

U.S. Pat. App. Pub. No. 2021/0142229 to Young, Share, Ramirez, Mazure, **Chau** (Granted January 18, 2024)

U.S. Pat. App. Pub. No. 2024/0185147 to Fong, Chan, **Chau**, et al. (Granted January 3, 2025)
 U.S. Pat. App. Pub. No. 2024/0273422 to Young, Share, Ramirez, Mazure, **Chau** (Granted March 17, 2026)
 U.S. Pat. App. Pub. No. 2026/0037889 to Fong, Chan, **Chau**, et al.

PRESENTATIONS & PROFESSIONAL ACTIVITIES

2026	Northwestern AI for Law Scholars Conference	Presenter & Discussant
	Central States Law Schools Association Annual Scholarship Conference	Presenter
	Thomas Edison Innovation Law and Policy Workshop	Presenter
	Center for Law, Information and Creativity Work in Progress Workshop	Presenter
	AI for Law Workshop	Reviewer
2025	Conference on Data Science and Law	Presenter
2024	Stanford Law School's Law and Society in an Age of Crises	Presenter
	Yale Law School's Propaganda and Emerging Technologies Conference	Presenter
	JustAI's JUST-AI Jean Monnet Summer Colloquium	Presenter
	Public Governance and Emerging Technologies: Values, Trust, and Compliance by Design	Presenter
2023	ACM Conference on Fairness, Accountability, and Transparency	Reviewer
	Media Law and Policy Scholars Conference	Presenter
2022	Yale Law School's Technologies of Deception Conference	Discussant

GRANTS & FELLOWSHIPS

Fellowships at Auschwitz for the Study of Professional Ethics (2023)
 American Foreign Law Association John N. Hazard Fund Research Grant (2021)
 NAPABA Law Foundation Chris Nakamura Scholarship Recipient (2020)
 NAPABA Law Foundation UPS/NLF Gold Mountain Scholarship Recipient (2019)

LEGAL EXPERIENCE

U.S. Senate, Washington, DC

Senior Law and Technology Fellow, May 2026 – August 2026

U.S. Court of Appeals for the Federal Circuit, Washington, DC

Law Clerk to the Honorable Raymond T. Chen, March 2025 – February 2026

U.S. District Court for the Eastern District of Texas, Texarkana, TX

Law Clerk to the Honorable Robert W. Schroeder III, March 2024 – March 2025

Fish & Richardson P.C., San Diego, CA

Associate, October 2022 – March 2024

- Drafted pleadings and motions, conducted source code reviews, and assisted with discovery in cases involving multi-million-dollar contracts and patent disputes

U.S. Court of Appeals for the Federal Circuit, Washington, DC

Judicial Intern to the Honorable Jimmie V. Reyna, August 2021 – December 2021

- Composed internal memoranda and assisted in drafting a bench memorandum

Fish & Richardson P.C., San Diego, CA

Summer Associate, June 2021 – July 2021 (offer extended)

- Analyzed taxable costs issue and prepared strategy for damages phase against an NPE

Desmarais LLP, New York, NY

Summer Associate, May 2021 – June 2021 (offer extended)

- Conducted legal research, drafted memoranda and subpoenas, and participated in discovery

Administrative Conference of the United States, Washington, DC

Legal Intern, September 2020 – December 2020

- Conducted legal research and drafted memoranda on agency rulemaking

Fish & Richardson P.C., San Diego, CA

Summer Associate, July 2020 – August 2020 (offer extended)

- Drafted patent claims and conducted legal research for use in IP litigation

Orrick, Herrington & Sutcliffe LLP, Menlo Park, CA

Summer Associate, June 2020 – July 2020 (offer extended)

- Wrote a Federal Circuit claim construction memorandum and participated in an oral argument moot

ENGINEERING EXPERIENCE

Lyft, Inc., San Francisco, CA

Senior Software Engineer, August 2017 – September 2019

- Led cross-functional teams in designing and implementing ridesharing features that generated more than \$20 million in annual revenue and resulted in multiple patents

Cisco Systems, Cambridge, MA

SaaS Software Engineer, August 2015 – July 2017

- Designed and implemented cybersecurity features to protect internet infrastructure

Silver Spring Networks, Redwood City, CA

Software Engineer, August 2010 – March 2014

- Designed and implemented Internet of Things features for a “smart grid” infrastructure

NASA Dryden Flight Research Center, Lancaster, CA

Student Research Intern, August 2009 – December 2009

- Created a program that improved the efficacy of data analyses, reducing the time of analysis from a month to a few days

BAR ADMISSION

State of California